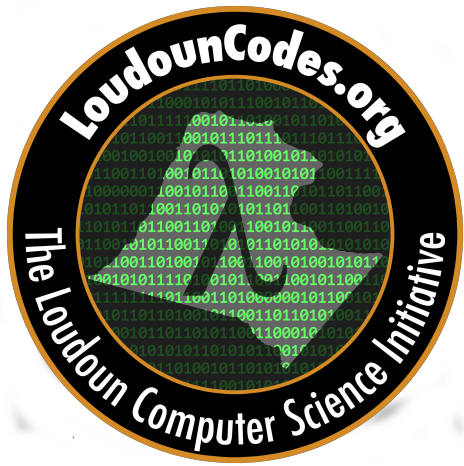




Karel

Creative Project Lessons

LoudounCodes

Java 18 · jGRASP

Classroom review edition · October 2026

About this library and curriculum

LoudounCodes JKarel extends the familiar Karel classroom environment into a setting for student-designed games, simulations, and visual projects. It is a modernization of the original Fairfax County Public Schools Karel library, with clearer API names, support for newer Java versions, and additional ways to construct and control the world. This edition targets Java 18 and retains the Ant build and jGRASP workflow used in the classroom.

Karel's small world gives students a useful foundation: actions have visible consequences, sensors support decisions, and a short program can express a complete solution. After students master those ideas, their questions often grow beyond the original assignments. Can a door open? Can two teams have different colors? Can the program keep score when a robot collects a beeper? This library gives those questions a practical place in the next stage of learning Java.

A clearer interface and a richer world

The API uses names that express the model students are working with. An `Arena` is the shared world; a `Location` identifies a grid position; a `Direction` represents a robot's facing. Calls such as `Arena.addNorthWall` and `Arena.setPace` read naturally as operations on that world. This more fluent vocabulary helps students distinguish scene construction from the actions of an individual robot, while typed directions and named pacing values make choices explicit in their code.

The added capabilities support projects whose worlds change during play. Students can build walls and beeper supplies programmatically, add or remove a door, assign colors to robots and beeper trails, and load another map while retaining a player. Listeners let a scorekeeper or another observer respond to movement and beeper activity. Custom items and robot drawing provide a way to give a project its own visual vocabulary. Students still write the rules, choose the sequence of actions, and decide what each event means in their game.

Java concepts with a visible purpose

The lessons introduce the concepts needed to use these capabilities. Enums describe directions and pacing. Subclasses give robots additional behavior. Interfaces let one object observe another, and rendering methods connect an object's role in the world with its appearance. These ideas arise from concrete project needs, so students can examine both the Java code and its visible result.

The library's internals also provide material for more advanced Java courses. Teachers can trace an action from the public API into the model, examine how listeners receive notifications, or discuss the responsibilities of an abstract item and its subclasses. The introductory lessons stay close to the public teaching interface; later work can use the implementation to investigate design choices, boundaries, and opportunities for improvement.

Using the curriculum

This sequence is intended for teachers and students who already know Karel or an earlier version of JKarel. The opening lesson explains the changes in terminology and API. The remaining lessons introduce individual capabilities, with a brief concept explanation, exercises, and complete commented programs in the appendix. The jGRASP setup instructions and teacher notes support classroom use.

Work through the sequence as a progression, or choose lessons to support an existing project. A maze may need changing walls; a team game may need colors and event scoring; a visual project may need custom rendering. The final map-interface lesson is an advanced design exercise that asks students to connect a declared contract to their own implementation. Throughout, the aim is to help students move from solving a supplied Karel problem to designing a program whose behavior they can explain, test, and extend.

Lesson guide

Start with the API orientation, then choose the features your own project needs. Print the selected lesson pages; complete program listings and teacher notes follow separately.

0. Names, types, and the Arena API
1. Robot and beeper colors
2. Interfaces and event scoring
3. Build walls, supplies, and doors
4. Pacing and STEP mode
5. Directions and protected behavior
6. Load maps and change levels
7. Custom items and robot rendering
8. AlphaBot lettering and infinite supplies
9. MapDataSource design extension

Set up in jGRASP

Use JDK 18 or later. The library targets Java 18; jGRASP's own minimum Java version is a separate requirement. The teacher builds once with ant and gives students out/jkarel-1.0.0.jar. Students do not need Ant or JUnit to run these labs.

In jGRASP, open **Settings** → **PATH/CLASSPATH** → **Workspace**, select **CLASSPATH**, then **New** and browse to that JAR. Apply the setting. If your classroom uses jGRASP projects, choose the project scope instead of Workspace. Remove an older JKarel JAR entry so the compiler and runner see the same library. Keep the original FCPS library available for assignments that still import edu.fcps.karel2; these labs import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.

Copy the example .java file into your own working folder, open it in jGRASP, compile, and run. The file name must match its public class name. Extra dependency JARs are not needed. The level-changing lesson needs its two map files copied beside the Java example; the other lessons build their own scenes.

- package org.loudouncodes.jkarel does not exist: check the CLASSPATH entry.
- UnsupportedClassVersionError: check the Java used to run in jGRASP; it needs 18+.
- A wall exception: read the failing line and use the appropriate ...IsClear() sensor before that move. The robot remains where it was.
- STEP pacing waits for Enter in the run console. FAST is used in the examples.

Teacher command-line equivalent, from the repository root:

```
ant
javac --release 18 -cp out/jkarel-1.0.0.jar -d build/labs examples/java/TeamTrails.java \
    examples/java/EventScoreboard.java
java -cp out/jkarel-1.0.0.jar:build/labs TeamTrails
java -cp out/jkarel-1.0.0.jar:build/labs EventScoreboard
```

On Windows, replace the runtime classpath's : separator with ;. Close each arena window before running the next example.

Lesson 0: Meet LoudounCodes JKarel

New terminology: Arenas, Locations, and Directions

You already know Karel. Learn these names to read the new API and build your own world and game rules.

Arena, Location, Direction

Arena is the shared world; Location is a grid position; Direction is a facing value. Arena methods operate on the scene. Robot methods act on one robot.

From a display to an arena

An arena names the place where robots, walls, and beepers interact. `Arena.addNorthWall(4, 3)` reads as an action in that place; `Arena.setPace(Pacing.SLOW)` names how its activity unfolds. These names express the model and make the API more fluent to read. These methods do not support chained calls.

Compare a familiar opening with the new version:

```
// Familiar FCPS-style opening:
// Display.openWorld("my-map.map");
// Display.setSpeed(5);
// Robot karel = new Robot(2, 2, Display.EAST, 2);

// JKarel opening:
Arena.openDefaultMap();
Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
Robot karel = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 2);
```

The changes to carry into your own code:

- Import `org.loudouncodes.jkarel` for these projects. Existing assignments that import `edu.fcps.karel2` still use their original library.
- Use `Arena.loadMap(name)` or `Arena.openDefaultMap()` to prepare a scene; `Arena.setSize(width, height)` sets the displayed grid.
- `Direction` is a `Direction`, not an integer. An arbitrary number cannot be passed as one. Choose a named `Pacing` value; there is no numeric speed conversion rule.
- `getLocation()`, `getX()`, and `getY()` describe a robot's grid position; `getDirection()` describes its facing.
- Infinite beepers use `BeeperStack.INFINITY`. Robots, walls, and stacks are kinds of `Item`; each describes how it is drawn.
- The normal robot verbs and sensors still work. Teach a subclass `turnRight` by calling `turnLeft` three times.
- `Arena` is the front door; `ArenaModel` holds the scene's state. `Arena.getModel()` exposes custom items and removable walls.

Predict and run

Compile `WelcomeArena.java` with the [jGRASP setup](#). Trace its two moves on paper before you run it. Expected output is location `[3, 3]`, direction `NORTH`, and inventory `1`. The dropped beeper stays at `[2, 2]`.

Change the initial direction to `NORTH`. Predict the new endpoint before running. Then change the pace to `Pacing.SLOW`. Explain why timing changes but the route and inventory do not. Read the console if an action fails; this version reports an exception at the failing line instead of quietly ending the program.

Show what you learned

Write a five-line opening for your own project. Explain which calls affect the arena and which affect one robot. Translate an opening from your own earlier work into the new names, and explain why a direction and a location are different kinds of information. Leave unrelated starter classes in their original package.

Teacher prompt: read an `Arena` call aloud as a sentence, then distinguish the front door from the stored scene. Leave `Swing` internals for a later course.

Lesson 1: Team trails

New capability: Robot/Beeper Colors

How could a player tell which team owns a trail? Build a small arena with two colored robots, then use the colors and walls in a project of your choice.

You should already be comfortable constructing a Robot, calling its methods, using loops, and checking a sensor. After this lab you should be able to create walls in code and explain how a robot's color affects its dropped beepers.

Robot/Beeper Colors

A robot has a drawing color. When it drops a beeper, that color applies to the whole stack. Color shows appearance; your program must keep team identity separately.

Predict, run, inspect

Open `TeamTrails.java` using the [jGRASP setup](#). Before running, sketch the grid. Predict the robots' final locations, their remaining inventories, and the colors of the beepers. Run it and compare with your sketch.

Expected result: a red trail on row 2 and a blue trail on row 4, each covering columns 2 through 6. Both robots end in column 6, with no beepers left. A wall separates the lanes. The program builds its own outer boundary.

Color comes from `java.awt`. Use `Color.RED`, `Color.BLUE`, or `new Color(80, 160, 220)`; each red/green/blue component is an integer from 0 to 255.

```
robot.setColor(Color.BLUE);
robot.putBeeper();
```

The drop colors the **whole stack** at that location. If a red robot later drops onto a blue stack, the stack becomes red. Picking up a beeper preserves the color of the remaining stack. Picking it up does not change the robot's color.

`Arena.addNorthWall(x, y)` places a unit wall immediately north of that cell. The East, South, and West methods work the same way. Adjacent calls can build a longer wall. `Arena.setSize` changes the displayed grid; it does not enclose it with a full boundary. Build boundaries explicitly, as this example does.

Exercises

1. Change both team colors. Explain why you need an import for `color`.
2. Change a robot's color halfway through its trail. Predict which beepers change.
3. Add a second divider with a gap. Write a robot route through the gap using turns and sensors; keep the route inside the boundary.
4. Have the robots meet and drop on the same cell. Test the whole-stack color rule.

Choose one extension for your project: colored territory, breadcrumbs through a maze, team bases, or a drawing made by several robots. Color is appearance, not a team identifier: keep a separate variable or robot reference for game rules.

Show what you learned

Show your arena and the code that builds it. Explain a north-wall coordinate, why a move is safe, and the result of two different colored drops on one cell. Give a prediction and observation for one change you made. Your program should finish its planned route without a wall exception or an empty-inventory drop.

Teacher prompts: ask why the loop avoids moving after the final drop; have a student point to the wall that a left-facing sensor would detect. Extra challenge: extract a reusable `buildRoom` method that takes a location and dimensions.

Lesson 2: Let the arena tell the scoreboard

New concept: Listeners

A game needs to count pickups and moves. Should every robot have to know about the scoreboard? Use an interface to let a separate observer react to arena events.

Complete Team trails first. You should know fields, methods, conditionals, and object references. This lab introduces an interface with default methods and the observer pattern: one object performs an action; another receives a notification.

Listeners

A listener is an object registered to receive notifications. The arena calls its methods when actions happen. The listener observes those actions without taking over the game loop.

Predict and run

Open `EventScoreboard.java` using the [jGRASP setup](#). Read `takeTurn` and `Scoreboard`. Predict the number of pickup callbacks and move callbacks before running.

Expected console results progress through red/blue scores of 1/0, 1/1, 2/1, and 2/2. The final line is `Final: Red 2, Blue 2, moves 8`. Both robots finish at column 6; each holds two beepers. The main loop drives the turns. The scoreboard never moves a robot.

```
Arena.addListener(scores);
```

This registers an object implementing `ArenaListener`. Its default methods do nothing, so the class overrides only the events it wants. `@Override` lets the compiler check the method name and parameter type. For a pickup the library calls `beeperPickedUp(Robot robot)` after updating the stack and inventory. Comparing `robot == red` tests whether this is the exact red robot object; its appearance could change while its identity stays the same.

Experiments

1. Move one beeper farther down its lane. Predict which turn produces its pickup.
2. Count drops separately by overriding `beeperDropped`. Add a drop in `takeTurn` after a pickup. Watch the scores: decide whether a pickup of a previously dropped beeper should award another point in your game.
3. Add a third robot and track it explicitly. Color alone must not determine score.
4. Remove the listener before the final turn. Explain why the robot still moves but that action no longer changes the observed counters.

Choose a project use: count maze steps, track food pickups, record a move log, or announce when a player has collected enough items. Write the win check in the main game loop after taking a turn; the callback can update a flag or counter.

Event scoreboard: callback rules

- Callbacks run immediately on the thread that performs the action. Keep them short. Do not start another movement or a game loop from a callback.
- `robotMoved` reports completed forward/backward movement; turns have no event.
- A robot drop produces `beeperAdded` followed by `beeperDropped`. Use the latter to count player drops; counting both would count one action twice.
- `robotAdded` runs before the constructor returns. Register scoring after player creation, as this example does; do not depend on subclass fields in that event.
- `wallCollision` observes an attempted blocked move before an exception is thrown. Sensors are still the right way to plan safe movement.
- `mapLoaded` fires after loading. Map loading preserves existing robots and listeners while replacing walls, beepers, and custom items.
- There are no keyboard-input, timer, turn, or color-change callbacks yet.

The `finally` block removes this listener even if a robot action fails. It does not reset the scoreboard, arena, or robots; those are separate responsibilities.

Show what you learned

Demonstrate one new counter or announcement. Explain the difference between calling a robot method and receiving a callback, why `pickup` sees the new inventory, and why the game loop belongs outside the listener. Include the predicted and observed callback counts for your change.

Teacher prompts: ask the student to trace one `move()` and one `pickBeeper()` into their callbacks. Extra challenge: add a second listener that records a text log; explain how it can coexist with scoring without modifying `Robot`.

Lesson 3: Build a room with a door

New capability: Programmatic Walls and Beepers

Maps need not be fixed before a game starts. Construct walls and beepers with loops, then let the program open a door. Use coordinates and conditions you already know to describe the world you want.

Programmatic construction

The program can place walls and beeper stacks while it runs. Loops describe repeated layout. Keep a wall object reference when the game needs to remove that specific wall.

Predict and run

Compile `RoomBuilder.java`. Sketch its 8-by-6 room, divider, and door. Predict what `frontIsClear()` reports before and after the door is removed. Run the example: the first result is `false`; the player then moves from `[4, 3]` to `[5, 3]`, picks up one beeper, and holds 1. Two beepers remain on that cell.

```
Arena.addEastWall(4, 2);
Arena.addBeepers(5, 3, 3);
Wall door = new Wall(4, 3, Arena.VERTICAL);
Arena.getModel().addWall(door);
Arena.getModel().removeWall(door);
```

North/South/East/West wall calls describe a wall relative to a cell. Each adds one segment. A loop builds a longer barrier. An east wall at `[4, 3]` separates columns 4 and 5. `Arena.setSize` changes the visible grid; construct enclosing walls explicitly.

Keep the `Wall` reference when you plan to remove it. Constructing another wall with the same coordinates does not give you the same object. Model-level wall changes appear on the next arena repaint; the following robot action supplies one here. Do not implement a game loop inside a wall event callback.

Exercises

1. Move the gap to another row. Change the player's starting location to match.
2. Keep the door closed until the player holds a key represented by a beeper.
3. Write a `buildRoom` method taking width and height, then build two room sizes.
4. Place food with `Arena.addBeeper` or supplies with `Arena.addBeepers`. Decide when a game should replenish them and express that rule in the main loop.

Show what you learned

Demonstrate a door changing a sensor result. Explain the difference between a wall coordinate and a robot location, and why removing the stored door object works. Your route must check the correct sensor before moving.

Teacher prompt: ask which cell lies immediately west of an east wall. Project extension: represent a maze with rows of characters and translate them into unit wall segments; begin with a small hand-written maze before random generation.

Lesson 4: Predict an action with STEP pacing

New capability: Pacing and STEP Mode

Slow a program down to explain it. Pacing is a named choice that changes how long the program waits between actions, while preserving the rules of the robot.

Pacing

Pacing controls the wait after an action. STEP waits for Enter in the run console. A named enum value selects timing; changing pace does not change the robot rules.

Predict and run

Compile `PaceProbe.java`. The robot is created at [3, 3], facing east, before the example switches to Pacing.STEP.

```
Arena.setPace(Pacing.STEP);
robot.move();
robot.turnLeft();
robot.move();
```

For each action, predict location and direction. Focus the jGRASP run console and press Enter when the program waits. STEP pauses after the action changes state and requests a repaint, before that call returns. It does not wait before the state change. The console traces are [4, 3] EAST, [4, 3] NORTH, and [4, 4] NORTH.

Creation, color changes, and several arena operations also use pacing. Setting STEP before constructing a robot can therefore pause in its constructor. For a clear movement trace, finish setup first as this example does. STEP uses console input, so do not combine it with another Scanner reading the same input stream.

Experiments

1. Compare SLOW, MEDIUM, FAST, and LUDICRUS using the same three actions. LUDICRUS is the exact spelling in this library. Confirm that the endpoint is identical even when you cannot watch every frame.
2. Insert a beeper drop with an appropriate starting inventory. Predict the inventory at each pause.
3. Pause a short section of your own project, then restore Pacing.FAST. Use `Arena.getPace()` to report the current choice.

Show what you learned

Submit a location/direction/inventory trace and demonstrate it in STEP mode. Explain why reducing delay cannot repair a wrong algorithm. For unattended graphical runs, this example accepts `--auto`; actual STEP behavior must be checked interactively in the classroom.

Teacher extension: read `Pacing.java`. Each enum value provides the same `tick` behavior with a different implementation. Name the strategy pattern only after students can explain the observable difference.

Lesson 5: Directions, sensors, and a retreating scout

New capability: Backing Up; New concept: Protected Methods

A robot can face one direction while checking another. Extend Robot with a retreat method and use typed directions to reason about its options.

Protected movement

Backing up changes position without turning. A protected method is available inside a subclass. Your Scout exposes a public retreat operation that checks the rear sensor before using backUp.

Predict and run

Compile `ScoutMoves.java`. Its Scout subclass starts at [3, 3], facing north. A wall is immediately west of it. Predict its left sensor, planned facing, and final position.

```
public void turnRight() {
    turnLeft(); turnLeft(); turnLeft();
}
public void retreat() {
    if (backIsClear()) backUp();
}
```

Expected results: left clear is false; the planned direction is EAST. After turning right, advancing, and retreating, the scout returns to [3, 3] and still faces east. Backing up changes position without turning.

`backUp()` is protected: a Robot subclass can call it, but the main program cannot call `robot.backUp()` on an ordinary Robot. The subclass exposes a meaningful operation, `retreat`, and checks its precondition. Public side sensors are available on any Robot. Each tests its own side relative to the current facing.

```
Direction planned = scout.getDirection().right();
```

This computes a direction value. It does not turn the scout. `left()`, `right()`, and `behind()` describe relations between enum values. `turnLeft()` is an action on the robot. Avoid integer arithmetic on directions or assumptions about their numeric order.

Exercises

1. Block the cell behind the scout and show that `retreat` leaves it in place.
2. Give the scout a `turnAround` method using two left turns.
3. Write `chooseExit` to inspect sensors and return a `Direction`. Keep choosing separate from the method that performs the actual turns and movement.
4. Use `nextToRobot(other)` for a meeting in a cooperative game. It means sharing a cell, not occupying neighboring cells; robots can share a location.

Show what you learned

Explain public versus protected with your own subclass. Demonstrate one method that computes an answer and another that changes the robot. Show safe movement when the front and back have different wall conditions.

Teacher prompt: rotate the paper sketch without changing the world walls and ask which relative sensor now detects the same wall.

Lesson 6: Change levels while keeping the player

New capability: Map Reloading

Move from one map to another during a program. First decide which state belongs to the map and which belongs to the player.

Map reloading

Loading replaces the map contents while keeping existing robots and listeners. Player position, facing, inventory, and your score variables survive. A level transition must decide which state to reset.

Set up and run

Copy `MapStages.java`, `stage-one.map`, and `stage-two.map` from `examples/maps` into the same student working folder. In jGRASP, compile and run the Java file from that folder. These maps were written for this lab; they are small XML files you can read and edit.

```
Arena.loadMap("stage-one.map");
// Take a turn using the current map.
Arena.loadMap("stage-two.map");
```

The example uses the current working folder by default. From the repository root, run it with the argument `examples/maps` to select the supplied map folder. If a map is missing, the library warns in the console and uses its default map; check the warning rather than assuming that an empty scene is your intended level.

Expected results: the player collects a beeper in level one. After level two loads, that same player remains at [3, 2], facing east, holding 1. A wall in the new map blocks its front. Loading replaces walls, beeper stacks, and custom items, but preserves existing robots and listeners. It does not reset player position, facing, inventory, or your score variables.

For a map already packaged in the JAR, `Arena.loadMap(Arena.DEFAULT_MAP)` selects the built-in default by its resource name. Local maps use file paths; this example keeps them beside the Java file for a predictable student setup.

The outer XML tag is still `world` for file compatibility. A wall's length expands into that many unit segments. Horizontal segments advance along `x`; vertical segments advance along `y`. You do not need a second XML library to load these files.

Experiments

1. Change level one's wall length. Predict the affected cells and check sensors.
2. Change a beeper count. Verify what is collected before the level transition.
3. Add a robot tag and explain why the new robot appears alongside the player.
4. Design a level-transition method that chooses explicitly whether to keep the player or remove it with `explode()` and construct a replacement.

Show what you learned

List the state that survives a load and the state that is replaced. Explain where your two files live and how the program finds them. Show that a new wall can affect an existing robot; avoid spawning it inside a wall layout you have not checked.

Teacher prompt: distinguish the map name requested by `mapLoaded` from proof that a missing-file fallback did not occur. Do not teach an automatic reset rule that the current implementation does not provide.

Lesson 7: Draw a goal and a different player

New capability: Custom Items and Rendering

Your game might need a target, a treasure marker, or a different-looking player. Give an object responsibility for drawing itself while keeping game decisions in the main loop.

Self-rendering items

An Item subclass supplies its drawing through render. The arena provides pixel coordinates; the item retains a grid location. Drawing describes appearance. The main loop supplies game behavior.

Predict and run

Compile `CustomItems.java`. A goal at [4, 2] is drawn as an outlined green target. A Robot subclass draws itself as a small blue square. After two eastward moves from [2, 2], the player reaches the goal; the main loop removes it and prints Reached the goal at [4, 2]. Use slow or STEP pacing to watch the target before it disappears.

```
private static class Goal extends Item {
    Goal(int x, int y) { super(x, y); }
    public void render(Graphics g, int x, int y) {
        g.drawOval(x - 12, y - 12, 24, 24);
    }
}
```

Item is abstract. Its render method is the drawing contract, and your subclass must supply an implementation. Register a completed goal with `Arena.getModel().addUserItem(goal)` and remove it with `removeUserItem(goal)`. A custom item is decorative until you write its behavior: a Goal does not become a wall, beeper, or collision automatically.

The x and y passed to render are pixel coordinates chosen by the arena. The Item's `getX()` and `getY()` are grid coordinates. Draw relative to the passed pixels. Rendering may happen many times on Swing's painting thread: do not move robots, change scores, pause, or modify the arena inside render.

Compare grid positions with `player.getLocation().equals(goal.getLocation())`. Using `==` would ask whether two references identify the same Location object. Read locations for decisions; use a subclass's protected `updatePosition` method when designing an item that can relocate, rather than changing another object's returned Location.

Exercises

1. Change the outline or marker size. Show that appearance does not change location.
2. Keep the goal after the player arrives and make the main loop announce it once.
3. Override the player's drawing with a circle, triangle, or shield. Keep robot movement and sensors working. A custom render override must decide how to show direction; it does not receive the default robot icon automatically.
4. Track additions and removals in a listener. The existing `userItemDropped` callback name means removal of a custom item.

Show what you learned

Explain abstract Item versus concrete Goal, pixel versus grid coordinates, and rendering versus a game rule. Demonstrate one custom item and one custom robot appearance without introducing side effects in rendering.

Teacher extension: ask what a treasure interface would promise to the game. Start with a small behavior such as an integer point value; do not make every visual item responsible for the entire game loop.

Lesson 8: A robot that draws letters

New capability: Robot Lettering

Use an existing Robot subclass to turn a short message into beeper art. Then inspect how a larger behavior is composed from familiar robot actions.

Lettering and infinite supplies

AlphaBot composes ordinary moves and drops into bitmap letters. Its unlimited inventory uses `BeeperStack.INFINITY`, a special value. The current lettering routine supports ASCII characters on a clear route.

Predict and run

Compile `RobotLettering.java`. It imports AlphaBot from `org.loudouncodes.jkarel.demo`, opens a blank 24-by-12 arena, sets a fast pace, and writes HI in blue beepers.

```
AlphaBot sign = new AlphaBot();
sign.setColor(Color.BLUE);
sign.say("HI");
```

AlphaBot starts at [2, 1], facing north, with `BeeperStack.INFINITY` beepers. Its inventory stays infinite after drawing. This sentinel represents an unlimited supply; it is not an ordinary negative inventory. A robot can use an infinite starting inventory, and a map can contain an infinite stack.

Each character is drawn using an 8-by-8 bitmap. Start with uppercase ASCII letters and a short message on an empty arena. The current font table accepts characters with codes 0 through 127; other characters are not supported. Walls can obstruct the drawing route, and the library does not expand the visible grid for a longer message automatically. Increase its width before drawing more letters.

Investigate and extend

1. Write a two-letter initial or short ASCII word. Predict the space it needs.
2. Change color between calls to `say`. Existing letters keep their stack colors.
3. Read `say`, `drawLetter`, and `scanLine` in AlphaBot. Explain how one public operation delegates to several small private methods and ordinary robot verbs.
4. Sketch an 8-by-8 symbol on paper, then write your own small drawing robot for a trophy or team emblem. Begin with loops and beepers before bit operations.

Show what you learned

Show your message, explain why the inventory does not run out, and trace one part of the drawing into moves and drops. Identify a limitation of AlphaBot and a change you would need before using it as a general message renderer.

Teacher prompt: distinguish an unlimited inventory from a scoreboard's numeric count. This is a worked example of inheritance and decomposition, not a requirement that students use the font-table implementation in their own game.

Lesson 9: An interface that describes a map

New concept: MapDataSource Interfaces (Design Exercise)

Advanced design extension. You know how to build an arena and observe its events. Now separate a description of a map from the code that installs it.

Data-source interfaces

An interface specifies what information an object supplies. Different implementations can describe maps. Here a student-written adapter installs that description; the library does not yet load MapDataSource objects directly.

Read the contract

MapDataSource declares four methods: width, height, beeper stacks, and walls. An implementation could describe a fixed room or a generated maze. A caller can use the interface without needing to know how that description was produced.

This is a design seam in the current library. Arena.loadMap accepts a String; there is no Arena.loadMap(MapDataSource) overload, and the XML loader is not wired through this interface. This exercise supplies its own small adapter, using operations you have already practiced. It does not change the library.

Predict and run

Compile `DescribeAMap.java`. TrainingMap implements the interface, while install accepts any MapDataSource.

```
private static void install(MapDataSource source) {
    Arena.openDefaultMap();
    Arena.setSize(source.getWidth(), source.getHeight());
    for (Wall wall : source.getWalls())
        Arena.getModel().addWall(wall);
    for (BeeperStack stack : source.getBeepers().values())
        Arena.getModel().putBeepers(stack.getLocation(),
            stack.getBeepers(), stack.getColor());
}
```

Expected result: an 8-by-6 map with one north wall at [3, 3] and two beepers at [4, 2]. The player walks there and collects both, ending with inventory 2. Setup finishes before the player is constructed. The adapter's map reset has the same robot-preservation semantics as the map-loading lesson.

Make a second implementation

1. Write SupplyRoom implements MapDataSource with a different size and layout. Install it using the same method; do not add a second installation method.
2. Explain the Map<Location, BeeperStack> and List<Wall> return types. The Map is a Java collection indexed by locations; it is not the whole game map.
3. Choose a policy for returned collections: newly built descriptions, snapshots, or read-only views. Explain whether callers can change your source accidentally.
4. Sketch a future library overload and its tests: colored stacks, long walls, existing robots, and listener notifications. Discuss before implementing it.

Show what you learned

Demonstrate two map-source implementations using one adapter. Explain an interface promise, an implementation choice, and an adapter responsibility. Identify exactly which part is supported by the current library and which part you wrote.

Teacher prompt: compare this interface, which is queried for data, with ArenaListener, whose methods receive notifications. Keep the initial example small; random-maze generation and dependency refactoring belong to a later project.

Complete example programs

Copy each listing into a file with the name shown and run it separately in jGRASP. For MapStages, also copy both map files from the listings below into that working folder. The same sources are in examples/java and examples/maps.

WelcomeArena.java

```
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class WelcomeArena {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        // Arena calls prepare the shared world before we add a robot.
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setSize(8, 6);
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        // Constructor arguments: column, row, facing, starting inventory.
        Robot explorer = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 2);
        // Robot calls change this robot; the dropped beeper stays behind.
        explorer.putBeeper();
        explorer.move();
        explorer.turnLeft();
        explorer.move();
        System.out.println("Location: " + explorer.getLocation());
        System.out.println("Direction: " + explorer.getDirection());
        System.out.println("Inventory: " + explorer.getBeeper());
    }
}
```

TeamTrails.java

```
import java.awt.Color;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

/** Extension lab 1: two teams leave colored trails inside a student-built arena. */
public class TeamTrails {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setSize(8, 6);
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        buildWalls();

        Robot red = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 5);
        Robot blue = new Robot(2, 4, Direction.EAST, 5);
        // Drops use the robot color; team identity is stored in these variables.
        red.setColor(Color.RED);
        blue.setColor(Color.BLUE);

        // Five drops need only four moves: both trails end in column 6.
        for (int step = 0; step < 5; step++) {
            red.putBeeper();
            blue.putBeeper();
            if (step < 4) {
                if (red.frontIsClear()) red.move();
                if (blue.frontIsClear()) blue.move();
            }
        }
        System.out.println("Both teams left five beepers, from column 2 through column 6.");
    }

    private static void buildWalls() {
        // setSize changes the visible grid. These loops create the boundaries.
        for (int x = 1; x <= 8; x++) {
            Arena.addSouthWall(x, 1);
            Arena.addNorthWall(x, 6);
        }
        for (int y = 1; y <= 6; y++) {
            Arena.addWestWall(1, y);
            Arena.addEastWall(8, y);
        }
        // A divider between the two teams' lanes.
        for (int x = 2; x <= 6; x++) Arena.addNorthWall(x, 2);
    }
}
```

EventScoreboard.java

```
import java.awt.Color;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

/** Extension lab 2: observe moves and pickups without putting scoring in Robot. */
public class EventScoreboard {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setSize(8, 6);
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        for (int x = 2; x <= 6; x++) Arena.addNorthWall(x, 2);
        Arena.addEastWall(6, 2);
        Arena.addEastWall(6, 4);
        Arena.addBeeper(3, 2); Arena.addBeeper(4, 2);
        Arena.addBeeper(3, 4); Arena.addBeeper(4, 4);

        Robot red = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 0);
        Robot blue = new Robot(2, 4, Direction.EAST, 0);
        red.setColor(Color.RED); blue.setColor(Color.BLUE);
        Scoreboard scores = new Scoreboard(red, blue);
        // Register before actions so the scoreboard receives their callbacks.
        Arena.addListener(scores);
        try {
            // The main program controls movement; the listener only observes it.
            for (int turn = 0; turn < 4; turn++) {
                takeTurn(red);
                takeTurn(blue);
            }
            scores.printResult();
        } finally {
            // Remove the observer even if an action throws an exception.
            Arena.removeListener(scores);
        }
    }

    private static void takeTurn(Robot robot) {
        if (robot.frontIsClear()) robot.move();
        if (robot.nextToABeeper()) robot.pickBeeper();
    }

    private static class Scoreboard implements ArenaListener {
        private final Robot red;
        private final Robot blue;
        private int redScore;
        private int blueScore;
        private int moves;

        Scoreboard(Robot red, Robot blue) {
            this.red = red;
            this.blue = blue;
        }

        @Override
        public void robotMoved(Robot robot) {
            if (robot == red || robot == blue) moves++;
        }

        // Object identity identifies the player, even if its color changes.
        // The pickup has already changed the inventory when this is called.
        @Override
        public void beeperPickedUp(Robot robot) {
            if (robot == red) redScore++;
            if (robot == blue) blueScore++;
            System.out.println("Red: " + redScore + " Blue: " + blueScore);
        }

        void printResult() {
            System.out.println("Final: Red " + redScore + ", Blue " + blueScore
                + ", moves " + moves);
        }
    }
}
```

RoomBuilder.java

```
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class RoomBuilder {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setSize(8, 6);
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        // A visible grid size does not build walls; these loops do.
        for (int x = 1; x <= 8; x++) {
            Arena.addSouthWall(x, 1);
            Arena.addNorthWall(x, 6);
        }
        for (int y = 1; y <= 6; y++) {
            Arena.addWestWall(1, y);
            Arena.addEastWall(8, y);
        }
        // Leave a gap in the divider, then fill it with a removable door.
        for (int y = 2; y <= 5; y++) {
            if (y != 3) Arena.addEastWall(4, y);
        }
        // Keep this exact object so we can remove this wall later.
        Wall door = new Wall(4, 3, Arena.VERTICAL);
        Arena.getModel().addWall(door);
        Arena.addBeepers(5, 3, 3);
        Robot player = new Robot(4, 3, Direction.EAST, 0);
        System.out.println("Door closed, front clear: " + player.frontIsClear());
        // Opening the door changes the sensor result before the next move.
        Arena.getModel().removeWall(door);
        if (player.frontIsClear()) player.move();
        if (player.nextToABeeper()) player.pickBeeper();
        System.out.println("Player " + player.getLocation() + ", inventory " + player.getBeepers());
    }
}
```

PaceProbe.java

```
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class PaceProbe {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        Robot robot = new Robot(3, 3, Direction.EAST, 0);
        // Use --auto for an unattended graphical demonstration.
        boolean auto = args.length > 0 && args[0].equals("--auto");
        // STEP pauses after an action; Enter lets execution continue.
        Arena.setPace(auto ? Pacing.FAST : Pacing.STEP);
        System.out.println("After each action, press Enter in the run console.");
        robot.move();
        System.out.println(robot.getLocation() + " " + robot.getDirection());
        // Turning changes facing while preserving the location.
        robot.turnLeft();
        System.out.println(robot.getLocation() + " " + robot.getDirection());
        robot.move();
        System.out.println(robot.getLocation() + " " + robot.getDirection());
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
    }
}
```

ScoutMoves.java

```
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class ScoutMoves {
    private static class Scout extends Robot {
        Scout() { super(3, 3, Direction.NORTH, 0); }
        public void turnRight() { turnLeft(); turnLeft(); turnLeft(); }
        // A subclass can call protected backUp; check the rear first.
        public void retreat() { if (backIsClear()) backUp(); }
    }
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        Arena.addWestWall(3, 3);
        Scout scout = new Scout();
        System.out.println("Left clear: " + scout.leftIsClear());
        // This computes a direction value without turning the scout.
        Direction planned = scout.getDirection().right();
        System.out.println("Planned direction: " + planned);
        scout.turnRight();
        if (scout.frontIsClear()) scout.move();
        // Move backward without changing the eastward facing.
        scout.retreat();
        System.out.println("Scout " + scout.getLocation() + " " + scout.getDirection());
    }
}
```

MapStages.java

```
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class MapStages {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        // In jGRASP, keep both map files beside this program.
        String mapFolder = args.length == 0 ? "." : args[0];
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        Robot player = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 0);
        // An anonymous listener needs to override only the callback we use.
        ArenaListener observer = new ArenaListener() {
            public void mapLoaded(String name) { System.out.println("Loaded: " + name); }
        };
        Arena.addListener(observer);
        try {
            Arena.loadMap(mapFolder + "/stage-one.map");
            if (player.frontIsClear()) player.move();
            if (player.nextToABeeper()) player.pickBeeper();
            // Reloading replaces map contents but preserves this player.
            // Its position, facing, and inventory survive the transition.
            Arena.loadMap(mapFolder + "/stage-two.map");
            System.out.println("Same player: " + player.getLocation() + ", inventory " + player.getBeepers());
            System.out.println("New wall blocks front: " + !player.frontIsClear());
        } finally {
            Arena.removeListener(observer);
        }
    }
}
```

CustomItems.java

```
import java.awt.Color;
import java.awt.Graphics;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class CustomItems {
    private static class Goal extends Item {
        Goal(int x, int y) { super(x, y); }
        // x and y are pixel centers supplied by the arena, not grid cells.
        public void render(Graphics graphics, int x, int y) {
            graphics.setColor(Color.GREEN);
            graphics.drawOval(x - 12, y - 12, 24, 24);
            graphics.drawLine(x - 8, y, x + 8, y);
            graphics.drawLine(x, y - 8, x, y + 8);
        }
    }
    // Override drawing while inheriting the normal robot actions and sensors.
    private static class Player extends Robot {
        Player() { super(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 0); }
        // x and y are pixel centers supplied by the arena, not grid cells.
        public void render(Graphics graphics, int x, int y) {
            graphics.setColor(getColor());
            graphics.fillRect(x - 8, y - 8, 16, 16);
        }
    }
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.FAST);
        Goal goal = new Goal(4, 2);
        Arena.getModel().addUserItem(goal);
        Player player = new Player();
        player.setColor(Color.BLUE);
        for (int turn = 0; turn < 2; turn++) {
            if (player.frontIsClear()) player.move();
            // The game loop decides when the goal is reached; drawing does not.
            if (player.getLocation().equals(goal.getLocation())) {
                Arena.getModel().removeUserItem(goal);
                System.out.println("Reached the goal at " + player.getLocation());
            }
        }
    }
}
```

RobotLettering.java

```
import java.awt.Color;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.demo.AlphaBot;

public class RobotLettering {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        // Leave a clear route and enough room for the lettering routine.
        Arena.setSize(24, 12);
        Arena.setPace(Pacing.LUDICRUS);
        AlphaBot sign = new AlphaBot();
        sign.setColor(Color.BLUE);
        // AlphaBot draws ASCII letters with moves and colored beeper drops.
        sign.say("HI");
        // Unlimited supplies use a named sentinel, not an ordinary count.
        System.out.println("Infinite inventory: " + (sign.getBeeper() == BeeperStack.INFINITY));
    }
}
```

DescribeAMap.java

```
import java.util.ArrayList;
import java.util.HashMap;
import java.util.List;
import java.util.Map;
import org.loudouncodes.jkarel.*;

public class DescribeAMap {
    // The interface describes map data independently of installation.
    private static class TrainingMap implements MapDataSource {
        public int getWidth() { return 8; }
        public int getHeight() { return 6; }
        public Map<Location, BeeperStack> getBeepers() {
            // Return a fresh collection indexed by grid locations.
            Map<Location, BeeperStack> beepers = new HashMap<>();
            beepers.put(new Location(4, 2), new BeeperStack(4, 2, 2));
            return beepers;
        }
        public List<Wall> getWalls() {
            List<Wall> walls = new ArrayList<>();
            walls.add(new Wall(3, 3, Arena.HORIZONTAL));
            return walls;
        }
    }
    // This is OUR adapter. Arena has no loadMap(MapDataSource) overload yet.
    private static void install(MapDataSource source) {
        Arena.openDefaultMap();
        Arena.setSize(source.getWidth(), source.getHeight());
        // Translate the interface data into existing model operations.
        for (Wall wall : source.getWalls()) Arena.getModel().addWall(wall);
        for (BeeperStack stack : source.getBeepers().values())
            Arena.getModel().putBeepers(stack.getLocation(), stack.getBeepers(), stack.getColor());
    }
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Arena.setPacing(Pacing.FAST);
        // Finish constructing the scene before creating the player.
        install(new TrainingMap());
        Robot player = new Robot(2, 2, Direction.EAST, 0);
        player.move(); player.move();
        while (player.nextToABeeper()) player.pickBeeper();
        System.out.println("Player " + player.getLocation() + ", inventory " + player.getBeepers());
    }
}
```

Map files for the level-changing lesson

stage-one.map

```
<world>
  <properties><defaultSize width='8' height='6'></properties>
  <objects>
    <beeper x='3' y='2' num='1'>
    <wall x='2' y='3' length='3' style='horizontal'>
  </objects>
</world>
```

stage-two.map

```
<world>
  <properties><defaultSize width='8' height='6'></properties>
  <objects>
    <wall x='3' y='2' length='2' style='vertical'>
    <beeper x='5' y='4' num='3'>
  </objects>
</world>
```

Teacher notes and sources

Teacher acceptance

Before giving the JAR to students, run the examples in the actual classroom jGRASP installation. Check red and blue robots/trails in the first lab; check pickup scores and the final eight-move count in the second. Check STEP interactively in the run console and check the map files from the student working folder. Java installation and visual display are classroom checks, separate from the automated Ant tests.

Sources and reuse

The exercises and example programs were written for this repository; they do not adapt the restricted Fairfax worksheets. The library's Fairfax/Loudoun ancestry remains documented in the root README. These files use the repository's existing [GPL version 3 license](#); no separate curriculum license is introduced by these labs. A broader curriculum publication can make that choice explicitly later.

The jGRASP setup instructions are independently written from the official [jGRASP installation tutorial, chapter 1, PATH/CLASSPATH section](#) and [project tutorial, chapter 7](#), version 1.8.7 (2009), accessed 2026-10-08. These are citations for setup facts; no tutorial text or figures are reproduced. Menus may vary with classroom version.

Brand asset: the selected master_logo.png from the personal Dropbox Marketing/logos collection, copied unchanged. The artwork is retained in the repository; the PDF places it on the cover; lesson pages use only limited spot color.

Feature coverage and teaching boundaries

The sequence is written from the implementation and repository history, rather than inferring capabilities from unfinished Javadoc. These are original exercises. The program sources form the reproducible examples; no Fairfax worksheet is adapted.

Feature or change	Lesson	Actual teaching surface
Display → Arena; Coordinate → Location; simpler package	0	Arena facade, Robot location accessors, <code>org.loudouncodes.jkarel imports</code>
Typed direction rather than numeric constants	0, 5	Direction enum; left/right/behind compute values
Robot and whole-stack beeper colors	1	<code>setColor/getColor</code> ; colored drops; existing stack color survives pickup
ArenaListener behavior interface and default methods	2	<code>addListener/removeListener</code> ; synchronous notifications; score outside Robot
Programmatic walls and beepers, removable doors	3	directional wall calls; <code>addBeeper/addBeepers</code> ; stored Wall reference
Named pacing and STEP	4	Pacing enum; Enter in run console; setup and action pause semantics
Protected backup and reusable subclasses	5	<code>backUp</code> inside Scout; <code>backIsClear</code> ; position versus facing
Runtime map reload; bundled and local maps	6	<code>loadMap(String)</code> ; existing player/listener persistence; XML wall length
Self-rendering objects and generic user items	7	abstract Item; <code>add/removeUserItem</code> ; Robot.render override; grid versus pixels
Letter-drawing robot and infinite supply ownership	8	<code>demo.AlphaBot.say</code> ; <code>BeeperStack.INFINITY</code> ; ASCII and layout limits
A data-source interface for future maps	9	MapDataSource descriptor; explicit student-written installation adapter

Orientation teaches the vocabulary without claiming the old and new APIs are source-compatible or that fluent naming means method chaining. Robot meeting sensors, ordinary subclassing, and game loops are supporting concepts; not every inherited operation is labeled as a new feature.

The event lesson covers movement and pickup scoring. Its experiments cover drops and unregistering; other lessons exercise map-load events and custom-item removal. ArenaListener documents its remaining callbacks, constructor timing, and lack of turn/color notifications. Do not invent a timer or keyboard event API for these labs.

The map-data interface is declared but not integrated into the XML loader. Lesson 9 is explicitly an advanced design exercise; its adapter lives in the example code. The existing JRuby experiments, Ant/JUnit packaging, XML internals, and Swing frame access are teacher/developer tools outside this Java/jGRASP student sequence. Digit is a legacy class, not a new feature; the lettering lesson uses AlphaBot.

Implementation and history anchors

The root README records the Fairfax/Loudoun lineage. API facts were checked in `src/main/org/loudouncodes/jkarel`, including `Arena`, `Robot`, `Direction`, `Pacing`, `ArenaModel`, `ArenaListener`, `Item`, `MapDataSource`, and `demo/AlphaBot.java`. The early API comparison was checked against commit `12e7e0f`'s `Display` and `Robot`. Useful provenance points in this repository's history:

- `a0df5a8`: `Direction` enum; `369f0cf`: Location naming; `8247185`: Arena naming.
- `5feb72b`: `pacing`; `ed94517`: robot rendering; `8a8dc3e`: generated walls/beepers.
- `524f07d`: lettering robot; `71bde07`: infinity moves to `BeeperStack`.
- `8a81d21`, `ea2f68f`, `f041915`: listener introduction, events, default methods.
- `40e9092`, `a784563`: custom items and protected repositioning.
- `be5152e`: `MapDataSource` declaration; `7de0d9f`: robot/beeper colors.
- `3f6969e`: protected backup; `f2e09d8`: runtime map reload.
- `5e07f3e`: classroom correctness repairs and completed callbacks.

These anchors establish provenance within the supplied code repository. They are not claims that a change originated nowhere else. The jGRASP setup references, license, and reuse notes appear in the main lesson README and PDF teacher notes.